BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #6 · CHRONIC PAIN

"This pain will never end."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Pain that lasts for months or years teaches the mind to expect only more pain. Each flare confirms the fear, and hope for relief becomes dangerous. Sleep loss and worry magnify the experience.

What Scripture teaches

The psalmist cries, "How long, O LORD?" and later says, "I will sing to the LORD, for He has been good to me" (Psalm 13). "For He has not despised or detested the torment of the afflicted. He has not hidden His face from him, but has attended to his cry for help." "Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning." We cannot promise relief, but we can say that God hears, that you are not alone in the pain, and that today's suffering is not the whole story.

> *"For He has not despised or detested the torment of the afflicted. He has not hidden His face from him, but has attended to his cry for help"* (Psalm 22:24).

Also see

> "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning" (Psalm 30:5).

> "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit" (Psalm 34:18).

> "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!" (Lamentations 3:22–23).

> "I consider that our present sufferings are not comparable to the glory that will be revealed in us" (Romans 8:18).

Common self-statements

- It will always be like this.
- Relief is impossible.
- I cannot survive more years of this.
- Hope just makes it worse.
- Nothing helps.
- This is my life now.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing pain is either gone or forever.
- Fortune telling: Predicting endless pain.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling pain intensely and concluding it will not end.
- Labeling: Calling myself a person in permanent pain.

Challenging questions

- What patterns do I notice in my pain, such as better and worse times?
- What has helped even a little?
- Who is on my care team, and have I told them everything?

- How have I coped before when pain eased?
- What does God do with the cry “How long?”
- What can I do today to make today a bit more bearable?

Truth summary

> God hears my cry and does not despise my pain. I cannot see the end, but I can take today one hour at a time, use every wise help available, and trust that He is with me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Suffering
- Sickness
- Hardship
- Prayer, Answers to
- Tired

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God’s care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God’s companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "This pain will never end"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"This pain will never end." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What patterns do I notice in my pain, such as better and worse times?
- ☐ What has helped even a little?
- ☐ Who is on my care team, and have I told them everything?
- ☐ How have I coped before when pain eased?
- ☐ What does God do with the cry "How long?"
- ☐ What can I do today to make today a bit more bearable?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God has not despised my torment.
- ☐ He attends to my cry for help.
- ☐ Weeping may last the night; joy comes.
- ☐ The Lord is near to the brokenhearted.
- ☐ His mercies are new each morning.
- ☐ I can face today.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 22:24
  "For He has not despised or detested the torment of the afflicted. He has not hidden His face from him, but has attended to his cry for help."
- ☐ Psalm 30:5
  "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning."
- ☐ Psalm 34:18
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] One hour at a time: Each day, note one thing that eased the pain a little.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 22:24 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord has not despised my torment and hears my cry.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Suffering" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Keep a pain log. Note patterns and what helps.
- [ ] Talk with your care team. Ask about new options.
- [ ] Pace your day. Plan rest and gentle activity.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 13. Tell God how you feel.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "This pain will never end": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One hour at a time
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~This pain will never end.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, the pain is wearing me down. You do not despise my suffering. Hear my cry, give strength for today, and lead me to the help I need. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #7 · CHRONIC PAIN

“I can't take one more day of this.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When pain, exhaustion, and discouragement pile up, one more day can seem unbearable. This is a human response to overload, and it can also be a warning sign that more support is needed.

What Scripture teaches

Elijah was so exhausted that he asked God to take his life. God did not scold him. He sent rest, food, and an angel who said, “Get up and eat, or the journey will be too much for you” (1 Kings 19:7). Jesus said, “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest.” “Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you.” Paul adds, “My grace is sufficient for you.” God gives strength for each day, not all at once. If you are thinking of ending your life, call or text 988 now.

> *“Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you; He will never let the righteous be shaken”* (Psalm 55:22).

Also see

> “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest” (Matthew 11:28).

> “But He said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.’ Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me” (2 Corinthians 12:9).

> “Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!” (Lamentations 3:22–23).

> “Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness” (Isaiah 41:10).

Common self-statements

- I cannot go on.
- I am at the end.
- I have nothing left.
- I do not know how I will get through today.
- Everything is too much.
- I just want it to stop.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I can either bear everything or nothing.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that tomorrow will be unbearable.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling overwhelmed and concluding that I cannot continue.
- Labeling: Calling myself unable to cope.

Challenging questions

- What exactly feels unbearable right now?
- What have I gotten through before that felt impossible?

- What is the smallest next step for this hour?
- Who can I call or be with right now?
- What basic needs, such as food, rest, and medication, need attention?
- What does God say to the weary?

Truth summary

> I do not have to carry tomorrow today. God gives grace for this day, and I can take the next small step and reach out for help. If I think of harming myself, I will call or text 988 right away.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Tired
- Suffering
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Hopeless
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I can't take one more day of this"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I can't take one more day of this." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly feels unbearable right now?
- ☐ What have I gotten through before that felt impossible?
- ☐ What is the smallest next step for this hour?
- ☐ Who can I call or be with right now?
- ☐ What basic needs, such as food, rest, and medication, need attention?
- ☐ What does God say to the weary?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God sustains me.
- ☐ Jesus gives rest to the weary.
- ☐ His grace is sufficient.
- ☐ His mercies are new each morning.
- ☐ I can take the next step.
- ☐ I can reach out for help.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 55:22
  "Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you; He will never let the righteous be shaken."
- ☐ Matthew 11:28
  "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9
  "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Next small step: Each day, note one small step you took and one person you contacted.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 55:22 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Jesus gives rest to the weary.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Tired" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Call someone today. Reach out to a friend or your doctor.
- [ ] Meet basic needs. Eat, hydrate, rest, and take medication as prescribed.
- [ ] Break the day down. Plan just the next hour.
- [ ] If life feels unbearable, call or text 988 (U.S.). Call 911 in an emergency.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I can't take one more day of this": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Next small step
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can't take one more day of this.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am so tired. Sustain me today. Send the help I need and let Your grace be enough for this hour. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #8 · CHRONIC PAIN

"I can't be happy as long as I hurt."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Pain narrows attention, and joy can seem like something that belongs to healthy people. We may stop doing what we enjoy and give up on laughter, connection, and meaning until the pain is gone.

What Scripture teaches

Paul wrote, "I have learned to be content regardless of my circumstances," and described himself as "Sorrowful, yet always rejoicing" (2 Corinthians 6:10). The psalmist says, "When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul" (Psalm 94:19). Joy is not the absence of pain. It is a gift that can exist beside pain, in small and real moments, and in the nearness of God.

> *"When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul"* (Psalm 94:19).

Also see

> "I know how to live humbly, and I know how to abound. I am accustomed to any and every situation—to being filled and being hungry, to having plenty and having need. I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength" (Philippians 4:12–13).

> "Sorrowful, yet always rejoicing; poor, yet making many rich; having nothing, and yet possessing everything" (2 Corinthians 6:10).

> "Then Nehemiah told them, 'Go and eat what is rich, drink what is sweet, and send out portions to those who have nothing prepared, since today is holy to our Lord. Do not grieve, for the joy of the LORD is your strength.'" (Nehemiah 8:10).

> "You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand" (Psalm 16:11).

Common self-statements

- Happiness is impossible while I hurt.
- I do not deserve to enjoy anything.
- Joy would be fake.
- Hurting people cannot laugh.
- I will be happy when the pain stops.
- Nothing feels good.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either pain-free and happy or miserable.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I cannot enjoy anything.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling pain and concluding joy is impossible.
- Labeling: Calling myself unable to enjoy life.

Challenging questions

- When have I felt a moment of peace or joy despite pain?

- What small pleasures are still possible?
- What did Paul and the psalmists experience in suffering?
- Whom do I enjoy being with?
- What would I tell a friend who felt this way?
- What gentle joy can I plan this week?

Truth summary

> Joy and pain can exist together. I can look for small gifts each day, receive God's consolation, and enjoy what I can, without waiting for the pain to end.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Joy
- Suffering
- Thankful
- Sickness
- Hardship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Thinking, Healthy
- Weak/Tired

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I can't be happy as long as I hurt"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I can't be happy as long as I hurt." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ When have I felt a moment of peace or joy despite pain?
- ☐ What small pleasures are still possible?
- ☐ What did Paul and the psalmists experience in suffering?
- ☐ Whom do I enjoy being with?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend who felt this way?
- ☐ What gentle joy can I plan this week?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God's consolations delight my soul.
- ☐ I can be sorrowful yet rejoicing.
- ☐ Contentment can be learned.
- ☐ Joy is found in His presence.
- ☐ Small joys count.
- ☐ I can enjoy what I can.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 94:19
  "When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul."
- ☐ Philippians 4:12–13
  "I know how to live humbly, and I know how to abound. I am accustomed to any and every situation—to being filled and being hungry, to having plenty and having need. I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 6:10
  "Sorrowful, yet always rejoicing; poor, yet making many rich; having nothing, and yet possessing everything."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Small joys: Each day, name one moment of joy or peace.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 94:19 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God's consolations delight my soul even in pain.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Joy" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List possible joys. Write simple things you can still enjoy.
- [ ] Plan one this week. Schedule a gentle activity.
- [ ] Share it. Tell someone about the moment.
- [ ] Thank God. Name one gift each night.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I can't be happy as long as I hurt": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Small joys
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can't be happy as long as I hurt.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, pain has taken my joy. Give me Your consolation, help me notice small gifts, and let me enjoy what I can. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #9 · CHRONIC PAIN

“If doctors can't find the cause, it must be all in my head.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Pain without a clear test result is common. When scans are normal, some patients are dismissed, and many begin to doubt themselves. Self-doubt can lead to shame, silence, and stopping the search for help.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus took seriously the suffering of the woman with bleeding who had spent everything on doctors and was no better, and He said, “your faith has healed you. Go in peace and be free of your affliction” (Mark 5:34). Pain is real whether or not it appears on a test. Scripture says, “I am weary from groaning” (Psalm 6:6) and “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds.” God is a compassionate Father who believes you, even when others struggle to. Keep seeking help, because medicine does not know everything.

> *“‘Daughter,’ said Jesus, ‘your faith has healed you. Go in peace and be free of your affliction.’”* (Mark 5:34).

Also see

> “I am weary from groaning; all night I flood my bed with weeping and drench my couch with tears” (Psalm 6:6).

> “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds” (Psalm 147:3).

> “For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who was tempted in every way that we are, yet was without sin” (Hebrews 4:15).

> “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed” (Proverbs 15:22).

Common self-statements

- No test shows anything, so I am imagining it.
- I must be crazy.
- I am exaggerating.
- The doctors are right and I am wrong.
- I should stop complaining.
- Nobody can help me.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing pain is either visible on tests or imaginary.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one will ever believe me.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling dismissed and concluding I am imagining it.
- Mind reading: Calling myself a complainer.

Challenging questions

- What do I know about my pain from my own experience?
- Who has believed me and taken me seriously?
- What have I not yet tried, such as a pain specialist or a second opinion?

- What do I want to say to my care team?
- What does Jesus' care for the suffering woman say about my pain?
- Who can go to appointments with me?

Truth summary

> My pain is real, even when tests are normal. I can keep seeking help, speak plainly with my care team, and rest in a God who believes me and cares.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Sickness
- Suffering
- Therapy
- Wisdom
- Hardship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If doctors can't find the cause, it must be all in my head"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If doctors can't find the cause, it must be all in my head." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I know about my pain from my own experience?
- ☐ Who has believed me and taken me seriously?
- ☐ What have I not yet tried, such as a pain specialist or a second opinion?
- ☐ What do I want to say to my care team?
- ☐ What does Jesus' care for the suffering woman say about my pain?
- ☐ Who can go to appointments with me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My pain is real.
- ☐ Jesus cares for those who suffer.
- ☐ God binds up the brokenhearted.
- ☐ Seeking counsel is wise.
- ☐ I can keep looking for help.
- ☐ God does not dismiss me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Mark 5:34
  "'Daughter,' said Jesus, 'your faith has healed you. Go in peace and be free of your affliction.'"
- ☐ Psalm 6:6
  "I am weary from groaning; all night I flood my bed with weeping and drench my couch with tears."
- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Heard and helped: Each week, note one step you took to get care.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Mark 5:34 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Jesus cares about my suffering, seen or unseen.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Sickness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Write your story. List symptoms, timing, and what helps.
- [ ] Bring someone. Take a friend to an appointment.
- [ ] Seek another opinion. Ask about specialists or pain clinics.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 147:3. Rest in God's care.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If doctors can't find the cause, it must be all in my head": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Heard and helped
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If doctors can't find the cause, it must be all in my head.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, no one can find the cause, but You know my pain. Give me persistence, wise doctors, and people who believe me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #10 · CHRONIC PAIN

“People think I'm faking.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Invisible pain and unpredictable symptoms leave room for doubt. Remarks like “But you look fine,” or being accused of attention-seeking, hurt deeply. Some patients start hiding symptoms or over-explaining to prove they are sick.

What Scripture teaches

Job’s friends accused him of hidden sin instead of believing his pain, and God rebuked them for not speaking about Him accurately, as His servant Job had (Job 42:7). Jesus had compassion on the suffering and never demanded that they prove it. “For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses.” “Man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.” God sees what others cannot, and some people will believe you.

> *“For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who was tempted in every way that we are, yet was without sin”* (Hebrews 4:15).

Also see

> “But the LORD said to Samuel, ‘Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.’” (1 Samuel 16:7).

> “You have taken account of my wanderings. Put my tears in Your bottle— are they not in Your book?” (Psalm 56:8).

> “O LORD, You have searched me and known me. You know when I sit and when I rise; You understand my thoughts from afar. You search out my path and my lying down; You are aware of all my ways” (Psalm 139:1–3).

> “Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep” (Romans 12:15).

Common self-statements

- No one believes me.
- They think I am lazy.
- I have to prove I am sick.
- I cannot explain what it is like.
- Everyone doubts me.
- I am being judged.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people either see my pain or think I am faking.
- Fortune telling: Predicting disbelief.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling doubted and concluding that everyone doubts me.
- Mind reading: Calling myself a fraud.

Challenging questions

- Who believes me, even if only a few?
- What do I want others to understand?

- How do I feel when I over-explain?
- What does God see?
- How could I set a boundary with people who doubt?
- Who might benefit from a patient-support group?

Truth summary

> God sees and knows my suffering, and Jesus sympathizes. I do not have to prove my pain to everyone. I can find those who believe me and set kind boundaries with those who do not.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Suffering
- Sickness
- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Judgmental

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

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- ☐ What do I want others to understand?
- ☐ How do I feel when I over-explain?
- ☐ What does God see?
- ☐ How could I set a boundary with people who doubt?
- ☐ Who might benefit from a patient-support group?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus sympathizes with my weakness.
- ☐ God sees my heart.
- ☐ God counts my tears.
- ☐ He knows me completely.
- ☐ I do not have to prove my pain.
- ☐ Some people believe me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Hebrews 4:15
  "For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who was tempted in every way that we are, yet was without sin."
- ☐ 1 Samuel 16:7
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✦ ✦ ✦

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- [ ] List supporters. Write those who take you seriously.
- [ ] Prepare a short sentence. Write one line for explaining your condition.
- [ ] Join a support group. Find people with similar conditions.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 56:8. Remember God counts your tears.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

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What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People think I'm faking": _____ % My truth: _____ %

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THE LIE

~~People think I'm faking.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

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Prayer

Lord, others doubt my pain, but You know it fully. Give me peace, supportive people, and grace to set boundaries. Amen.

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